

“Supporting earthquake affected Dalit community to increase access for them to the reconstruction”

Feminist Dalit Organization (FEDO)
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Patandhoka, Lalitpur



FEDO with Earthquakes Survivors at the beginning

- ❖ During the rescue and relief phase, with the national and international support generated through its network and provided support to the earthquake affected people with its limited resources
- ❖ Despite immense support from neighboring and international communities, Dalits in general and Dalit women in particular were faced discrimination in every aspect of their lives, the rescue and relief support
- ❖ FEDO immediately responded by providing lifesaving relief
- ❖ Limited resources worked effectively to support affected people



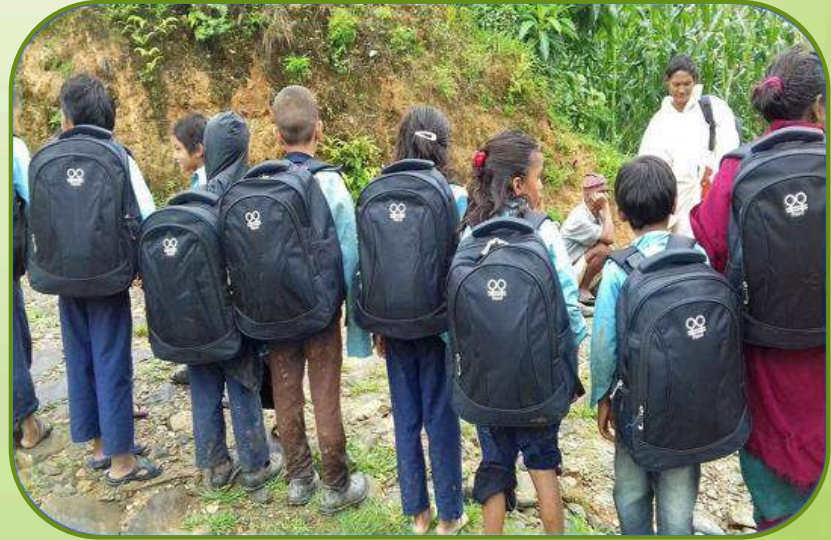
Immediate Response

- ❖ Immediate distribution of ready-to-eat food items, blankets, hygiene kits, emergency lights, sanitary items, medications, radio sets
- ❖ A total of 65 temporary shelters were built in Kavre and Kathmandu (more than 1450 affected families were staying there)
- ❖ lifesaving support provided to over 7900 people based on the immediate needs
- ❖ As the majority of the affected people from Dalit community are living in the extreme condition, we could not be able to reach all due to resource constraints



Support to school going children

- ❖ FEDO provided school uniform, bags and stationary, including mosquito nets and sanitary kits to school going children of affected families
- ❖ A total of 846 students have been benefited with this support in Dhading, Nuwakot and Sindhupalchowk district



Support to construct toilets

- ❖ Supported in constructing 461 toilets for earthquake affected Dalit households in Boch and Sunkhani VDC of Dolakha and Manthali and Ramechhap Municipality of Ramechhap district
- ❖ Toilets were constructed in three community schools include:
Annapurna Primary School, Budhsing-3 of Nuwakot, Sunkhani Secondary School, Chainpur – 7 of Dhading and Seti Devi Primary School, Kunchowk-9 of Sindhupalchowk district



Organizing Dalit women

- ❖ In course of advocacy on their rights and issues, FEDO formed an mobilized Dalit women groups at affected districts i.e. Dhading, Nuwakot, Kavre, Sindhupalchowk, Dolakha and Ramechhap
- ❖ Dalit women frontline leaders and advocacy forums at local level helped Dalit women to organize and raise their voices collectively in accessing the local resources
- ❖ Group members have learnt a valuable lesson that a lot of things can be achieved through united efforts



Policy Influence

- ❖ FEDO in coordination with other like-minded networks, organizations conducted various interactions and advocacy to influence national policy
- ❖ National and international organizations dedicated in the field of women's rights including FEDO, organized a conference on *"Gender Responsive Disaster Management"*
- ❖ FEDO expressed its solidarity and cooperation to announce **'Kathmandu Declaration 2016'** as well which covers 15 points of action in relation to women and disaster



Research Study

- ❖ Realizing the needs and pertinent issues, FEDO completed a research study with the support of SDC in Dhading, Nuwakot, Kavre, Sindhupalchowk, Dolakha and Ramechhap and it identified the gaps and ways for filling up the gaps in service delivery
- ❖ There is general tendency to look Dalit women just as a vulnerable but their unique capacity for coping and resilience building can be crucial for recovery and reconstruction is rarely discussed
- ❖ Effort to reconstruct needs to be inclusive and based on the special needs of Dalits especially the Dalit women
- ❖ On the basis of the fact from the study we are seeking support to further advocate in addressing the gaps

FEDO for Reconstruction

- ❖ FEDO as an advocating organization having presence in 56 districts of Nepal has been working to ensure rights of women in general and Dalit women in particular
- ❖ Specifically, FEDO is planning to help affected Dalit community to increase their access in reconstruction services "build back better" through the following strategies and interventions:
 - Lobby and advocacy on ensuring meaningful participation in policy enforcement and decision making level to provide services to earthquake survivors of Dalit community and other excluded groups
 - Support on building earthquake-resistant shelters to help Dalit community get back better

- Support to Dalit women and children on education, health care access and water, sanitation and hygiene services
- Promotion and creation of economic/livelihood opportunities to help earthquake survivors rebuild their lives through reconstruction services and resources available from the government and non-government institutions
- Increase awareness on human trafficking, gender-based violence (GBV) and caste-based discrimination to support vulnerable communities
- Strong research-based advocacy through constructive engagement between government and civil society for ensuring justice to Dalit women and their community in reconstruction
- Coordination and collaboration with government bodies, networks, alliances, NGOs, UN agencies, INGOs

Some Photos





Thank you !